

Professional Bio
Shacunda Rodgers, Ph.D.
Licensed Clinical Psychologist

Dr. Shacunda (pronounced Sha-KON-da) Rodgers is a licensed clinical psychologist practicing in Sacramento, California. In her private practice, she provides individual, couples, and family psychotherapy. Her clinical interests include treating people with depression, anxiety, relationship problems, trauma, and grief & loss.

In addition to her private practice work, Dr. Rodgers is also the founder of Melanin Meets Mindfulness, a wellness-based program dedicated to teaching the principles of mindfulness, while centering the experiences of African-American women in the process. The mission of Melanin Meets Mindfulness is to create safe emotional spaces for African-American women to tap into their inner wisdom, guided by the principles of mindfulness: nonjudgment, compassion, and embracing the moment *as it is*. This wellness program offers mindfulness groups, workshops, seminars, wellness retreats, and trainings for groups and organizations.

In another area of serving her profession, Dr. Rodgers also serves on the California Board of Psychology (BOP). Appointed in November 2019 by Governor Gavin Newsom, she currently serves as Vice President, Chair of the Budget Committee, and the Outreach and Communications Committee, and is a member of the Disaster Preparedness Committee, formed in response to the COVID-19 pandemic. Additionally, she writes a self-care and wellness column for the quarterly BOP newsletter.

In 2020, Dr. Rodgers founded a nonprofit organization, Holding Space, whose mission is to improve the emotional health and wellbeing of people of African descent by providing a wide range of services and community offerings that are holistic, culturally competent, trauma informed and strength based. Its mission to heal race-based trauma comes at a critical time in our nation's history, and seeks to address the link between oppression and mental health using the lens of "heart-centered, liberation-focused" care. Launched in the Sacramento community in April 2023, at Holding Space, we believe that culture, community, and compassion are the medicines that heal.

In terms of educational background, Dr. Rodgers attended Vanderbilt University in Nashville, Tennessee, where she received her Bachelor's Degree, with Honors, in Psychology. She obtained her Ph.D. in Clinical Psychology at the University of Tennessee, Knoxville. She completed her pre-doctoral internship through the Yale School of Medicine at the Yale- New Haven Psychiatric Hospital, and her post-doctoral training took place at The University of California, Davis Medical Center, in the Department of Psychiatry.

When she is not working, you can find Dr. Rodgers spending time with her husband and trying to keep up with her 2 very active sons, reading, or sitting on her meditation cushion, sneaking in a moment of peace wherever she can find it.